

Vertigo

No 835 March 2020



NEW ZEALAND
ALPINE CLUB

Wellington Section Monthly Bulletin

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Shaun Barnett enjoying dusk photography while camping beside
Ariels Tarn (1,350m), near Harman Pass, with Whitehorn Pass left of
centre, Arthurs Pass Photo: Peter Laurenson [More here](#)

Chair's Report

March 2020

The end of the world as we know it ...

That was true of 9/11, arguably a smaller and less globally impactful event than Covid-19. Governments around the world, including New Zealand, are beginning to respond. However, governments are by definition, large, lumbering (slow), bureaucratic and inefficient - they are also political and rarely proactive. The PM's message of 'we must go hard and we must go early' is entirely appropriate for Covid-19. Sadly that isn't what most governments, including this one, have done.

No matter how bad Covid-19 is for our health and economy, there is a bigger, much more serious threat to life already underway that will make Covid-19 seem like nothing more than a bad fart in comparison. We all know what it is, but we don't want to do anything about it. Not yet anyway, because like Covid-19, we haven't had any confirmed cases of community transmission yet. So let's not try to prevent that from happening, let's wait until it does then try to do something about it.

With Covid-19 we are likely to have a vaccine in a year or two, even if we don't change our behaviour. With climate change there is no vaccine. The only thing we have available to us is changing our behaviour. Waiting until climate change is wiping out our communities before reacting is, like Covid-19, too late and unlike Covid-19, immensely more damaging and fatal. We need to go even harder on climate change, as we haven't gone early.

Ironically, the response to Covid 19 is quite significantly reducing CO2 emissions - cows are still farting but there are fewer international flights, less vehicle-based movement and now, no more pollution hazes over Beijing and some other major population centres. Could this be a silver lining in this cloud? Or will we just go straight back to our usual ways once Covid 19 has passed?

'All predictions are important
Most predictions are wrong
And I think we must be careful with that'
Dr Michael Ryan: WHO Health Emergencies Programme

Any comments on what you like or don't like send
an email to wellington@alpineclub.org.nz or
tweet us @NZACWellington.

Simon Williamson
Outgoing Chair: NZAC Wellington

Wanted - a new Section Chairperson!

After five years in the Section Chair role, Simon feels it's time to give someone new a chance to take our Wellington Section further. He has kindly agreed to act as outgoing Chair until the next AGM; and will remain an active member of the Section for the foreseeable future, so the new person will have support from him to answer questions and seek clarifications as required.

The Chair plays a pivotal leadership role in shaping the direction of the Wellington Section and ensuring that the Section Committee functions effectively, so that all facets of the Section are managed well. The Chair also represents the Section in an outward facing capacity with the national NZAC office, other Sections and the general public.

NZAC has a long proud history and is constantly evolving to reflect changes in our wider society. The Section Chair role offers someone wanting to give back to our club, while being both stimulated and challenged, a special opportunity to make a positive difference. If you're interested, [click here](#) to see a Role Description and contact Simon to discuss the role further - crisisresponse@googlemail.com, 021 054 7684.

From the editor

The March Vertigo - something to read should you be in self isolation. Or not. Incredible times - 'unprecedented' as everyone has been saying. Mind you, the hills are quite isolated - another good reason to get out there perhaps. Any questions or feedback about Vertigo, please let me know; and remember to send in your (self isolation) trip reports to occasionalclimber@gmail.com. Stay well! Peter

PS If you were looking in the February issue of Vertigo, the leaf shown was from a Mount Cook Lily. This image - Looking east at dawn to Hawkes Bay, from above [Toka Biv in the Ruahine Range](#)

Section News

Gear Hire

The Section has gear for hire: avalanche transceivers, ice axes, shovels, stakes, hammers, helmets, crampons, probes, PLBs, ice hammers (entry level). Each item costs \$5 per week with the exception of PLBs – PLBs are free but require a deposit of \$50 refundable on return. To hire gear please fill in the form [here](#). You can find out more from [Carolyn](#).

Some advance notice, especially over the Christmas period, is appreciated as gear is in higher demand and often needs to be retrieved from the gear store. To collect or return your gear liaise with Genevieve.

InReach for hire



We suggest that all climbing parties carry a PLB as well as the InReach. If there is demand the section will purchase another one or two. The benefit of the InReach is that you can send and receive text messages, receive weather forecasts, and send an SOS in an emergency.

The InReach comes with 3 preset messages: 1. Delayed but everything is ok; 2. Starting our trip now; 3. This is where we are. Messages received from the InReach include a link that can be used to see the location. When hiring the InReach you need to provide an email address that will receive the messages and also advise if you'd like to adjust the preset messages.

The InReach can be paired using bluetooth to a Smartphone which has the Earthmate app loaded. This makes it much easier to type in messages. We recommend that you take a powerpack to keep the device charged and also only turn the InReach on when you need to use it to save battery power.

There's a \$50 deposit for hiring the InReach and a hire charge of \$20 / week-end. Additional charges will be incurred if you request weather forecasts or use non-preset messaging. [Contact Carolyn](#) kaz1963@gmail.com to find out more.

Discounted PLBs

skippersmate.co.nz offers a 5% discount to all NZAC members for NZ purchases of PLBs. Two brands are on offer - KTI SA2G and McMurdo Fast Find 220 (not always in stock). To use the discount, the coupon code on the website is **NZAC05** and the owner, Peter, asks you to send a copy of your membership card to peter@cooeebay.com

Section nights

Our Commmitte has decided that our Section nights must be suspended until such time it is judged that gatherings of people do not present an unacceptable health threat any longer. When that is no-one yet knows, but we will keep you posted. Our 24th March gathering is definitely cancelled. Our April and May gatherings remain pencilled in and, if/when the situation permits, we will advise Section night resumption.

So, to look forward to at some future point ...

Jo Morgan will take us climbing in New Zealand's 3,000ers.

Paul Maxim will present his recent climbing in the European Alps, including Mont Blanc.

Change of (future) venue

Even if Covid 19 had not emerged, due to a change in their pricing policy, our last Section night at The Third Eye, Tuatara Brewery was to be 24th March. And from April on our venue would have reverted to the Guest Room at the Southern Cross Tavern, 39 Abel Smith Street, from 6pm. We shifted from this venue before because our then Wednesday evening time slot clashed with live band performances, which made hearing difficult. This is no longer an issue so, when our Section nights do eventually resume, we will be able to once again enjoy a good space and food and beverages.

If you would like to make a presentation at a future Section night, or have a suggestion about someone else to present, please let Peter know - occasionalclimber@gmail.com.



The Guest Room, Southern Cross Tavern

Notices

A cool story

Section Committee member Guy Dubuis shares ‘[No pain, no gain: Para-climber Rachel Māia 12 months on from leg amputation](#)’

More secondhand books from NZAC’s store available [here](#).

More copies of Summits and Shadows by Graham Langton available [here](#). Proceeds are being donated back to the Club’s DOW Hall Fund.

The Summit of Her Ambition: The Spirited Life of Marie Byles 1900-1979
Now available [here](#).

NZAC approved Round One 2020 Expedition Grants Find out more [here](#).

From Ngā Taonga Sound and Vision - Shackleton’s departure of the British Antarctic Expedition from Lyttleton, NZ 1 Jan 1908. View [here](#).

The Earle Riddiford Collection

Gifted to the Alexander Turnbull Library, see more [here](#).

Recycling ideas

Find out about NZAC’s recycling efforts and ideas [here](#).

More NZAC member discounts

New or recently renewed discounts:

Go Native - details [here](#).

Monster Merinos - details [here](#).

Outfitter - details [here](#).

An online discount code is viewable to members only once logged in.

All other discounted providers to NZAC members [here](#).

Mountain Safety Council – Focus Groups: Trip Planning Research

Mountain Safety Council is conducting trip planning research to better understand the approach outdoor recreation participants take when preparing for an outdoor experience. The findings will help to inform the development of trip planning resources and targeted outdoor safety campaigns.

We need your help! As part of the research we’ll be conducting a series of focus groups. These groups will consist of 8 – 10 people, covering a broad range of demographics and outdoor backgrounds. Register your interest to be part of a focus group [here](#).

International Youth Nature Environment Camp 2020

Inter-University Seminar House, Hachioji, Tokyo

28 July – 1 August 2020, for those aged 16-25 years

1 day climbing and study on Takao-san mountain, 1 day study and talk session about Global Warming and Nature Environment Protections.

More [here](#).

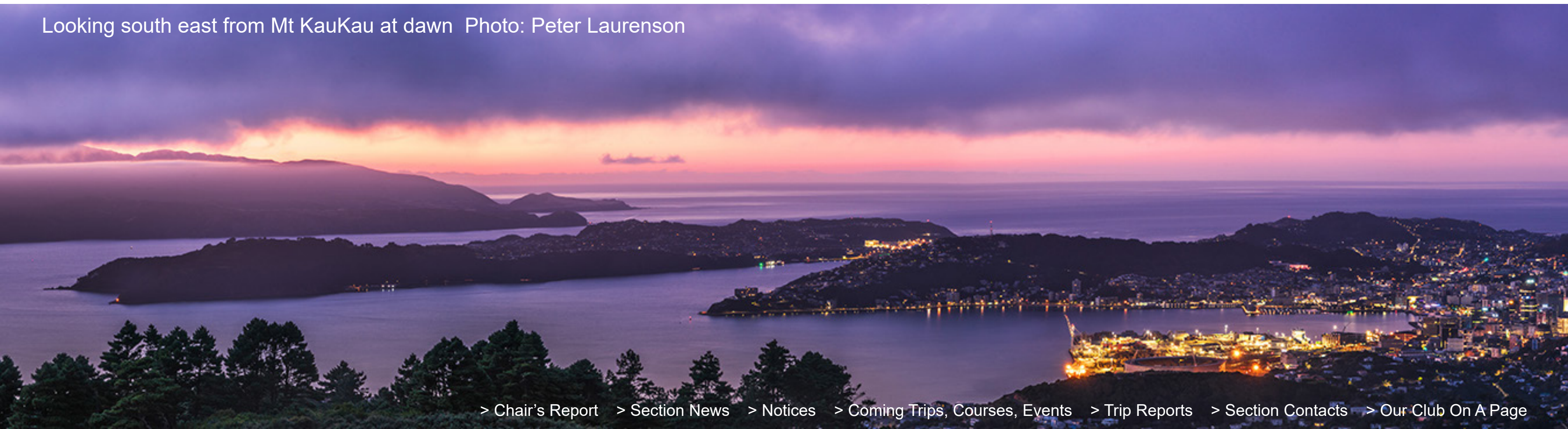
Booking DOC facilities online

Additional DOC facilities can now be booked online [here](#), including 10 high-demand campgrounds and 5 huts. Work is underway to transition all remaining bookable facilities to the new online booking platform before summer 2020/21.

News from the UIAA

The Indian Mountaineering Foundation (IMF) has informed the UIAA Office that for the 2020 climbing season, it will offer a 50% discount on handling charges to encourage foreign climbers to visit the Indian Himalaya. Full details are provided [here](#).

Looking south east from Mt KauKau at dawn Photo: Peter Laurenson



Coming Trips, Courses, Events

Covid 19 impact

While it is still judged that internal travel is acceptable our trips are still on, but the wider situation is, as you know, very fluid. Therefore check the up-to-date situation with each trip leader. If you have registered for a trip and since decided that you want to withdraw, please let the trip leader know as early as possible. And obviously, if you even suspect that you might have any Covid 19 symptoms, then your trip withdrawal will be mandatory.

All our planned South Island trips come with the added bonus that rental vehicle costs for Wellington Section members are covered by the Section.

If you're uncertain about the skill level required with any of the trips, would like to register your interest or to find out more, email us at wellington@alpineclub.org.nz.

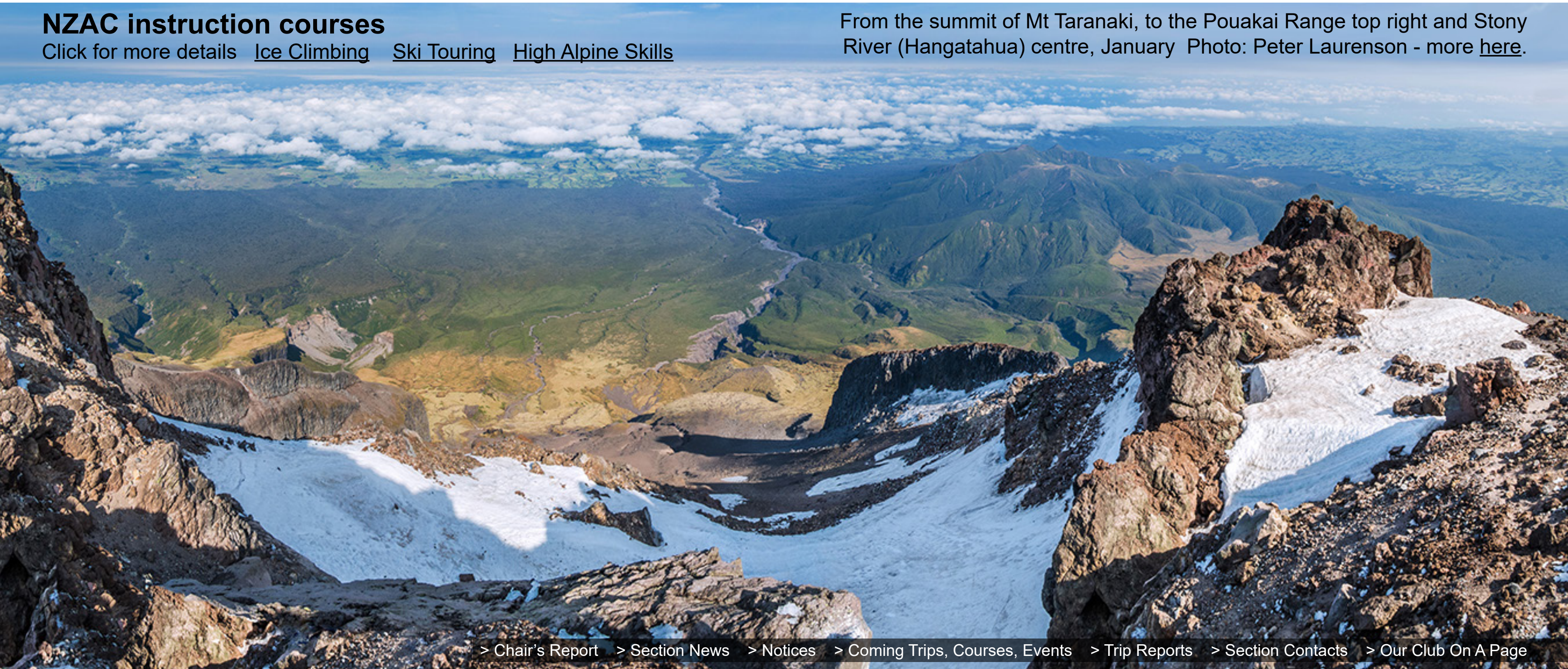
Also, please contact us if you're keen to run a trip yourself – the Committee can help with advertising and logistics.

When	What and where
10 - 14 April	Mount Somers Rock Climbing Trip Easter weekend, grade 2. Spaces are limited, so register your interest asap with Alexis Belton belton.alexis@gmail.com
29 May - 1 June	Flock Hill bouldering Trip leader Eric Duggan ericduggan@gmail.com
17 and 24 June	Banff Mountain film Festival 2020 Ticket sales are on hold until further notice.
24 - 26 July 31 July - 2 August 14 - 16 August 21 - 23 August	2020 Snowcraft courses Contact Nish Shah catchnishie@gmail.com Please note: a compulsory theory night for participants is on the Thursday night two weeks prior to each course. Participants will need to take the Friday afternoon off work to travel to the course venue.

NZAC instruction courses

Click for more details [Ice Climbing](#) [Ski Touring](#) [High Alpine Skills](#)

From the summit of Mt Taranaki, to the Pouakai Range top right and Stony River (Hangatahua) centre, January Photo: Peter Laurensen - more [here](#).



Trip Reports

Work With What You Get

Sam McCahon writes about how rain didn't defeat a Section trip to Queenstown, Wanaka and the Darrans



Mike Greer and Elliot O'Brien summit Mt Aspiring
Photo: Helpful Tourist?

As the group trickled into the Jet Star check-in area, we easily identified each other from the bags of climbing gear and massive grins. Psych was building as we headed off for a week of some of New Zealand's best sport and trad climbing.

We landed in Queenstown, grabbed some rental vehicles and shot over the Crown Range to go get our fingers on Wanaka schist. The long summer afternoon let us get a good volume done on the first day, becoming familiar with the local rock. Mellow warm-ups in the sun zoomed by and we soon found ourselves pulling out head-torches to snag one last send and clean the climbs before bed at the Glendhu Bay Campground.

Day two was a bit rainy and opinions differed on which crags would be dry, so people spread out and had different levels of success, though the general trend as the rain set in was that everything was getting a bit desperate. Cheesecake unlocked more energy and people drifted towards Mount Iron, where the overhangs are steep enough to stay dry in most weather. Mt Iron was really fun, a clear shift from the crimpy face-climbing Wanaka's famous for. The crag provided powerful moves between big holds on some rad juggy features and even the odd crack to jam.

Day three saw passing rain which kept increasingly tired climbers on overhangs and roofs to stay on dry rock. Hard climbers climbed hard while the wiser/weaker/more strategic athletes mixed naps into the lunch break, as the rain had broken for hot conditions that made quick work of our precious skin if we pulled hard in the sunshine.

After three days of climbing, heavy rain hit Wanaka on Tuesday and gave a welcome excuse to rest and recover before we shifted focus to the Darrans. We were excited to be heading down there and had plans for various trips to fit into whatever weather we got. This trip was to be the first time climbing in the Darrans and/or on granite for many group members and psych was high to get there.

Unfortunately while the rain was 'only' heavy in Wanaka on the sheltered side of the Main Divide, it was pretty biblical in the area around the Hollyford River and across the Main Divide to Lake Gunn. The road from Te Anau to the Darrans was closed, as the rivers swelled under and over sections of road. Sections of road were entirely washed away, as well as some sections of the Hollyford, as the flood rearranged the riverbed.



Elliot O'Brien descends
Mt Aspiring
Photo Mike Greer

Rather than think about all the awesome climbing we wouldn't be doing, people made new plans for all the great climbing that was still available. Stacey Wong and Kieran Liddicoat grabbed another rental vehicle, as they flew in to Queenstown with the intention of only climbing in the Darrans. The group split up, with Jurgen Osterle and Elliot O'Brien doing the Grand Traverse of the Remarkables, Elliot and Mike Greer climbed Mount Aspiring, Sam McCahon Michiko Nakagawa and Jess Thorn climbed Telecom Tower on the Remarkables and Ravages of Time over on Chinaman's Bluff, and plenty more sport climbing got done in Wanaka.

While the flood was devastating for certain regions, the rain didn't actually last long and climbing conditions were only really rotten for one day that just supported much-needed recovery. From the Remarkables, to Chinamans Bluff, to Wanaka crags, to Mt Aspiring, the group kept hitting good weather and climbing conditions. The odd shower or icy section of rock might not have been perfect, but I know I felt lucky to be out and able to find quality dry rock with roads that were more or less intact.

It was great to see climbers doing things right: staying up-to-date with the weather forecast, working around it rather than against it, and spending energy enjoying the outdoors rather than griping about the climbs we didn't get to do. While our goals in the Darrans were left unticked, we got plenty of good weather, with a great group of people to enjoy Wanaka and Queenstown climbing with. Now we have some great new friends to plan the next Darrans trip - hopefully that road gets fixed soon!



Above - Jessica Thorn tops out Indian Summer (18) on Telecom Tower, the Remarkables Photo: Michiko Nakagawa

Left - Well chuffed and getting one last cheesecake before home-time Photo: Sam McCahon

Bottom left - Paul Clarke on the classic Falcon Steep (22) Photo: Derek Cheng

Below - Margot Meuleman in action Photo: Derek Cheng



Section Contacts

Powered by volunteers

We're always thankful for volunteers and members stepping forward to help the section run smoothly. A lot goes on to keep our club going, virtually all powered by volunteers. On the back page is our "Club on a page" summary. It gives an at a glance description of all the things we do, how and why. Feel free to print a copy and pass it on to anyone who might be interested in becoming a member or volunteer. And if you'd like to learn more about how you could get involved, please email us at wellington@alpineclub.org.nz.

Role	Name	Contact
Outgoing Chair, course coordinator	Simon Williamson	021 054 7684
Treasurer	Eva Duncan	evaduncan@windowslive.com
Secretary, club liaison	Keith Munro	keithm@mtgelab.co.nz
Gear custodian	Carolyn Ellis	021 574 287
Trip co-ordinator	Stacey Wong	staceycolleena@gmail.com
Section nights, Vertigo, Banff	Peter Laurenson	occasionalclimber@gmail.com
Banff	Emma Hayward	emmahayward@windowslive.com
Photo comp	Guy Dubuis	guy.dubuis@gmail.com
Social media	Rosie Percival	calicoanne@gmail.com
Reel Rock	Naomi Seow	naomiseow@gmail.com
Social media	Derek Cheng	derekcheng.nz@gmail.com
Patron	John Nankervis	
Rock drill overseer	Jeremy Tries	027 555 5893

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* On average. Climbing competitions can interrupt our schedule.

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Registered Financial Adviser
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keithm@mtgelab.co.nz

Past performance is not necessarily a guide to future performance.

Our club on a page

WELLINGTON SECTION



NEW ZEALAND
ALPINE CLUB



WHAT WE DO

FOR MEMBERS

Facilities

- * Huts
- * Gear
- * Library
- * Discounts

Training

- * Level 1-3 winter skills
- * Summer rock
- * Instructors

Climbing trips

- * Section
- * National
- * International

FOR MEMBERS AND WIDER PUBLIC

Publications

- * Website
- * Social media
- * Vertigo
- * Guide books

Events

- * Banff mountain film festival
- * Reel Rock
- * Photo comp

Networking

- * Section nights
- * Conferences and meetings
- * Lobbying

HOW WE DO IT

Organise, encourage, support, enable

Inform, entertain, promote

OUR RESOURCES

Volunteer time and capabilities, income from events and gear hire, national office support, sponsorship

WHY WE DO IT

Connecting & developing more climbing & mountaineering people, knowledge, skills & experience, thereby ...

... building
lifelong
friendships

... protecting
and improving
access to
alpine places

... sustaining
and growing
climbing and
mountaineering
achievement

... enhancing
alpine
safety

... building
appreciation,
enjoyment and
protection of
alpine places

Image and diagram Peter Laurenson www.occasionalclimber.co.nz